

something the AI water use

Posted by u/Bra--ket • 0 points • 12 comments

AI Water Use

Interactive Report and LLM/diffusion "water cost" calculator tools:

[Report Link - <https://bra-khet.github.io/ai-water-use-report-1/>] (<https://bra-khet.github.io/ai-water-use-report-1/>) |

[LLM Prompt Calculator - see how much water your prompts actually use\]] (<https://bra-khet.github.io/ai-water-use-tool-1/>)

[Image/Video-Gen Calculator - see how much water AI gem machines actually use\]] (<https://bra-khet.github.io/ai-water-use-tool-2/>)

ai;tl;dr:

- * AI uses water *mainly* through **power** consumption, not cooling.
- * It still isn't very much compared to other things like **farming**, or others
- * **Image/video-generation is fairly power-intensive**, but local generation is much more efficient. Personally, I now understand why credits cost so damn much. It really does take some power, so then water.

If you want to find out more I suggest you read the report, it's fairly detailed but still digestible. I included as much as I could in the images.

My goal is to inform both Pro- and Anti-AI on what actually matters, and I hope this report is informative to everyone. The water (and energy) challenges in AI development are real, but by actually acknowledging what the real issues are, we can see that AI directly accelerates fixing those same problems of sustainable agriculture and energy grids. AI is the best tool we have for the job, and it's the solution to many of these problems.

Responsible and informed development, and responsible and informed use, makes AI's transformative power far outweigh the (often exaggerated) costs. Let's build the future where tech solves scarcity instead of debating it. In my view, we were already on an unsustainable path, but AI might be the the chance to fix that, and I don't think we really have another choice.

Also I didn't really like a couple of the conclusions in this report... but I do think they're representative of the truth. If you see anything you think is straight up false please let me know. I obviously applied careful, deliberate engineering of AI superiorization for helping me create all of this, and I've checked everything, but I'M only human. I'm sure Claude did ok, I'm more worried about me. I followed a set of guidelines to make sure the information was accurate and useful, you can read more about it on my homepage by clicking the "trust me bro" button. It's just github so I don't make money or anything so just check it out if you like stuff.

^(Made with Claude Code & Gemini Deep Research btw, brought to you by the entire Mississippi River)

Comments

u/No-Age-1044 • 3 points • 2026-03-24 21:13 UTC

668 years of IA equals to 1 burger.

I'm gonna eat a burger while I think about it...

u/Bra--ket • 2 points • 2026-03-24 22:08 UTC

Keep in mind the estimates vary wildly because even a small deviation in the statistics is a huge proportion of the comparison. It's only meant to be persuasive and demonstrative as an analogy, it literally cannot be precise 🤔

That's why I built the calculator-tool-things, it gives you a much better feel for it.

u/sunflow23 • 2 points • 2026-03-24 08:41 UTC

I am not going to read the details but i respect the efforts. .

From my understanding so far ,water use is very minimal compared to something like animal agriculture but it all depends on type of water used ,ai is becoming a issue because local governments are approving data centers in region where they have access to enough freshwater and don't have to put money into cleaning it from other sources and that freshwater is supply for residents there which lowers water pressure and increases electricity bill as well if they take it from grid (even though big ai companies seems to building their own infra to meet constant demand) . Not an ai issue but human issue. Ppl should be demanding their politicians if anything is to improve since ai isn't going anywhere.

Feel free to correct me though.

u/Bra--ket • 2 points • 2026-03-24 15:24 UTC

I can tell you didn't read it.

I address all of that in the report, that's the difference between gray, green and blue water. And if you only take into account blue water in agriculture, it's still dwarfs any AI water consumption figures.

u/Tyler_Zoro • 0 points • 2026-03-24 05:46 UTC

The number of times this flips between "datacenters" and "AI datacenters" makes it very clear that they're just generalizing any instance of computers inside a building, rather than talking about AI specifically.

u/Bra--ket • 1 points • 2026-03-24 06:02 UTC

I'm not sure what you mean. In what case does it reference something AI-related about datacenters that aren't running AI workloads?

Do you have a reason to believe the data centers in question don't apply to the conclusions? Because it all seems very straightforward to me.

u/Tyler_Zoro • 0 points • 2026-03-24 14:34 UTC

"US data center water consumption"

"As hyperscale data centers expand"

"75–90% of data centers worldwide"

None of these statements are AI-specific, and much of the data cited uses general data center footprint and resource consumption, but the conclusions drawn are all about AI.

This expand's AI's footprint and resource utilization to encompass all computing infrastructure, which is an absurd basis for any further claims.

u/Bra--ket • 1 points • 2026-03-24 15:22 UTC

Most parts of the report focus on US for consistency, if you look into the figures claimed it's all relevant to the conclusions, there's no conflating the facts just because you don't like the language.

If you could please cite the source that is incorrectly being applied? I would very much appreciate it. Or at least tell me what section you're talking about in the paper?

u/Tyler_Zoro • 0 points • 2026-03-24 15:49 UTC

> if you look into the figures claimed it's all relevant to the conclusions

You can't just make that claim and make it true by willing it. They're referring broadly to data centers as a whole, and then drawing conclusions that they put at the feet of AI. That's just wrong. It's flat-out wrong, and it's so prevalent in the discourse that people don't even notice the bait-and-switch anymore.

u/Bra--ket • 1 points • 2026-03-24 16:45 UTC

AI resource consumption is only being attributed to AI workloads in this report. The data is only being referenced in relevant contexts.

No statistics from "non-AI data centers" were used in this report if the claims were regarding "AI data centers". All of the sources undergo an industry-standard relevancy check. You can read all about it on my website. It's the same process journalists go through.

You need to specifically show me where my report made a false claim based on the sources I used, otherwise I don't know what you're talking about.

In general, you may be correct that other people don't distinguish between them when necessary. But where is this issue in my report specifically? I believe I specifically avoided making that mistake. If I failed in doing so I would like you to show me. Show me exactly what page it's on, please, or what source you're talking about.

u/Tyler_Zoro • 0 points • 2026-03-24 17:01 UTC

> AI resource consumption is only being attributed to AI workloads in this report.

It's not, and I showed you examples of where it's not. I'm not going to continue this conversation if you're not going to be realistic about the sources you're citing.

Have a nice day.

u/Bra--ket • 1 points • 2026-03-24 17:04 UTC

You show me examples where adjective use varies. But you haven't shown me where data has been misrepresented.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-24 05:43 UTC

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